CONTENT PITCH: *Guiding Quebec's Emerging Writers*
Prepared for: Quebec Writers' Federation
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Dear John Wickham,

My name is Laurie Legault, and I am a third-year creative writing major with a minor in professional writing at Concordia University. I am reaching out to pitch content ideas that can attract emerging writers and help expand their visibility in the Québec literary world. As an emerging writer myself—and aware of how difficult and intimidating the initiation process can be without guidance and experience—I understand what our community is looking for.

Writer's Roadmap: An expanding QWF Resource

Format: Digital resource hub *Frequency:* Updated regularly *Primary goal:* Inform and guide

Writer's Roadmap offers guidance on what is current in the literary world, with regularly updated, step-by-step advice on navigating the writing scene. This hub would include advice from established writers, "how-to" guidance on preparing manuscripts and approaching publishers, and links to current opportunities across Québec. This pitch aims to extend QWF's support for the community by centralizing information that can help emerging writers navigate the industry with ease.

- **Timeliness and potential**: Literary opportunities, application deadlines, grants, and calls for submissions change regularly. This evolving hub can keep information current and easily accessible.
- **Where**: QWF website/resource hub, newsletter, social media, complementing its existing resources and programming.
- **Platforms/formats to disseminate**: Newsletter features highlighting the newest seasonal opportunities; social media carousel post summarizing practical advice; downloadable checklist and linked application resources.

Behind the Red Pen

Format: Video or audio podcast *Frequency:* Monthly *Primary goal:* Demystifying the industry

Behind the Red Pen is an interview podcast series that invites publishing professionals from different stages of the editorial process, including editors, proofreaders, and literary agents. Episodes run 30-45 minutes and introduce the guest speaker, explore their career and responsibilities, and explain how they approach submissions. Audience members can submit questions in advance, allowing the series to address concerns directly relevant to emerging writers.

- **Timeliness and potential**: Accessible, practical guidance extending QWF's digital format content through audio and video. Each episode generates reusable content.

- **Where**: QWF website and podcast platforms. Episodes can be linked to through its newsletters and social media.
- **Platforms/formats to disseminate**: Full video episodes on YouTube; audio episodes on Spotify or other podcast platforms; written transcripts or adapted interviews on QWF's website; short clips and guest quotations for social media.

Emerging Voices

Format: Live event *Frequency:* Twice a year *Primary goal:* visibility and networking

Emerging Voices is a live showcase event designed to help emerging writers gain visibility. Writers apply by submitting writing samples, from which QWF selects a limited number of participants to read in front of an audience of editors, publishers, agents, established writers, and fellow emerging writers. Starting with readings and ending with an informal networking session for writers to touch base with people active in the industry, this event would take place twice a year (fall and summer, coinciding with university graduations when emerging writers may be seeking professional exposure). This event is inspired by QWF's speed-dating initiative: the focus here is exposure, networking and community-building rather than any promise of publication.

- **Timeliness and potential**: Emerging writers often need opportunities to share their work and establish connections beyond the classroom. An annual showcase could attract new participants and provide writers with some of their first professional experience.
- **Where**: Existing QWF event or book fair, supported by QWF website, newsletter, and social media.
- **Platforms/formats to disseminate**: Short recorded readings for TikTok, Instagram Reels, or YouTube Shorts (with performer's consent); an event recap for QWF website or magazine; newsletter coverage promoting participants and future event.

Conclusion: From roadmap to podcast to live event, these three pitches reflect exactly what emerging writers need. This initiative will help new writers tackle the critical stages of their careers by learning to navigate the industry, understand the people working in it, and gain important visibility. QWF already has a very strong presence in the Québec English literary community. This pitch aims to build on QWF's existing programming while also addressing opportunities to expand its digital presence and create new pathways for emerging writers to engage with the organization.